

“There comes a time in the life of every nation when it stands at the crossroads of history and must choose which way to go. But for us there need be no difficulty or hesitation, no looking to right or left. Our way is straight and clear—the building up of a socialist democracy at home with freedom and prosperity for all, and the maintenance of world peace and friendship with all nations.”

Lal Bahadur Shastri, 1964

The Indian prime minister is the head of the government and holds the most powerful political office in the country. Usually the head of the political party with the largest majority in Parliament, the prime minister has the power to set the priorities of the government and to choose ministers who will be closely involved in running the country. In addition to their governmental responsibilities, the prime minister is also the leader of the nation. In this capacity, they represent Indian democracy, and as such, are meant